
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 1 Aspects of dramatic tragedy

Wednesday 4 January 2023

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford International AQA Examinations 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the different characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 3

Enter Othello and attendants

OTHELLO

What is the matter here?

MONTANO

Zounds, I bleed still. I am hurt to th'death.

OTHELLO

Hold for your lives!

IAGO

Hold, ho, Lieutenant, sir, Montano, gentlemen!

Have you forgot all sense of place and duty?

Hold! The General speaks to you: hold, for shame!

OTHELLO

Why, how now, ho! From whence ariseth this?

Are we turned Turks and to ourselves do that

Which heaven hath forbid the Ottomites?

For Christian shame, put by this barbarous brawl.

He that stirs next to carve for his own rage

Holds his soul light: he dies upon his motion.

Silence that dreadful bell: it frights the isle

From her propriety. What is the matter, masters?

Honest Iago, that looks dead with grieving,

Speak, who began this? On thy love I charge thee.

IAGO

I do not know. Friends all but now, even now,
 In quarter and in terms like bride and groom
 Devesting them for bed: and then but now –
 As if some planet had unwitting men –
 Swords out, and tilting one at others' breasts
 In opposition bloody. I cannot speak
 Any beginning to this peevish odds;
 And would in action glorious I had lost
 Those legs that brought me to a part of it.

OTHELLO

How comes it, Michael, you are thus forgot?

CASSIO

I pray you, pardon me: I cannot speak.

OTHELLO

Worthy Montano, you were wont to be civil;
 The gravity and stillness of your youth
 The world hath noted; and your name is great
 In mouths of wisest censure. What's the matter
 That you unlace your reputation thus
 And spend your rich opinion for the name
 Of a night-brawler? Give me answer to it.

MONTANO

Worthy Othello, I am hurt to danger.
 Your officer, Iago, can inform you,
 While I spare speech, which something now offends me,
 Of all that I do know; nor know I aught
 By me that's said or done amiss this night,
 Unless self-charity be sometimes a vice,
 And to defend ourselves it be a sin
 When violence assails us.

OTHELLO

Now, by heaven,
 My blood begins my safer guides to rule,
 And passion, having my best judgment collied,
 Assays to lead the way. Zounds, if I stir,
 Or do but lift this arm, the best of you
 Shall sink in my rebuke. Give me to know
 How this foul rout began, who set it on;
 And he that is approved in this offence,
 Though he had twinned with me, both at a birth,
 Shall lose me. What! In a town of war
 Yet wild, the people's hearts brimful of fear,
 To manage private and domestic quarrel
 In night, and on the court and guard of safety,
 'Tis monstrous. Iago, who began't?

Turn over for the next question

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the different characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 2 Scene 4

GONERIL

Hear me, my lord;
What need you five-and-twenty, ten, or five
To follow, in a house where twice so many
Have a command to tend you?

REGAN

What need one?

KING LEAR

O, reason not the need! Our basest beggars
Are in the poorest thing superfluous.
Allow not nature more than nature needs –
Man's life is cheap as beast's. Thou art a lady;
If only to go warm were gorgeous,
Why, nature needs not what thou gorgeous wear'st,
Which scarcely keeps thee warm. But, for true need –
You heavens, give me that patience, patience I need!
You see me here, you gods, a poor old man,
As full of grief as age, wretched in both;
If it be you that stir these daughters' hearts
Against their father, fool me not so much
To bear it tamely; touch me with noble anger,
And let not women's weapons, water drops,
Stain my man's cheeks. No, you unnatural hags,
I will have such revenges on you both
That all the world shall – I will do such things –
What they are yet I know not; but they shall be
The terrors of the earth. You think I'll weep.
No, I'll not weep.
I have full cause of weeping; but this heart
Shall break into a hundred thousand flaws
Or ere I'll weep. O Fool, I shall go mad!

Exeunt KING LEAR, GLOUCESTER, KENT, and Fool

*Storm and tempest***CORNWALL**

Let us withdraw; 'twill be a storm.

REGAN

This house is little: the old man and's people
Cannot be well bestowed.

GONERIL

'Tis his own blame; hath put himself from rest
And must needs taste his folly.

REGAN

For his particular, I'll receive him gladly,
But not one follower.

GONERIL

So am I purposed.
Where is my lord of Gloucester?

CORNWALL

Followed the old man forth. He is returned.

*Re-enter GLOUCESTER***GLOUCESTER**

The King is in high rage.

CORNWALL

Whither is he going?

GLOUCESTER

He calls to horse; but will I know not whither.

CORNWALL

'Tis best to give him way. He leads himself.

GONERIL

My lord, entreat him by no means to stay.

GLOUCESTER

Alack, the night comes on, and the bleak winds
Do sorely ruffle. For many miles about
There's scarce a bush.

REGAN

O, sir, to wilful men
The injuries that they themselves procure
Must be their schoolmasters. Shut up your doors.
He is attended with a desperate train,
And what they may incense him to, being apt
To have his ear abused, wisdom bids fear.

CORNWALL

Shut up your doors, my lord; 'tis a wild night.
My Regan counsels well. Come out o' the storm.

Exeunt

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the different characters
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 1

HAMLET

If thou dost marry, I'll give thee this plague for thy dowry: be thou as chaste as ice, as pure as snow, thou shalt not escape calumny. Get thee to a nunnery. Go, farewell. Or, if thou wilt needs marry, marry a fool. For wise men know well enough what monsters you make of them. To a nunnery, go, and quickly too. Farewell.

OPHELIA

O heavenly powers, restore him!

HAMLET

I have heard of your paintings too, well enough. God hath given you one face, and you make yourselves another. You jig and amble, and you lisp. You nick-name God's creatures and make your wantonness your ignorance. Go to, I'll no more on't. It hath made me mad. I say we will have no more marriage. Those that are married already – all but one – shall live. The rest shall keep as they are. To a nunnery, go.

Exit

OPHELIA

O, what a noble mind is here o'erthrown!
The courtier's, soldier's, scholar's, eye, tongue, sword,
Th'expectancy and rose of the fair state,
The glass of fashion and the mould of form,
Th'observed of all observers, quite, quite down!
And I, of ladies most deject and wretched,
That sucked the honey of his music vows,
Now see that noble and most sovereign reason
Like sweet bells jangled, out of tune and harsh,
That unmatched form and feature of blown youth
Blasted with ecstasy. O, woe is me
T'have seen what I have seen, see what I see!

Re-enter KING CLAUDIUS and POLONIUS

KING CLAUDIUS

Love? His affections do not that way tend;
Nor what he spake, though it lacked form a little,
Was not like madness. There's something in his soul
O'er which his melancholy sits on brood,
And I do doubt the hatch and the disclose
Will be some danger; which for to prevent,
I have in quick determination
Thus set it down: he shall with speed to England
For the demand of our neglected tribute.
Haply the seas and countries different,
With variable objects, shall expel
This something-settled matter in his heart,
Whereon his brains still beating puts him thus
From fashion of himself. What think you on't?

LORD POLONIUS

It shall do well. But yet do I believe
The origin and commencement of his grief
Sprung from neglected love. – How now, Ophelia?
You need not tell us what Lord Hamlet said.
We heard it all. – My lord, do as you please,
But if you hold it fit, after the play
Let his Queen mother all alone entreat him
To show his grief. Let her be round with him,
And I'll be placed, so please you, in the ear
Of all their conference. If she find him not,
To England send him, or confine him where
Your wisdom best shall think.

KING CLAUDIUS

It shall be so.
Madness in great ones must not unwatched go.

Exeunt

Turn over for the next question

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus and Mephistopheles
- Marlowe's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 1

FAUSTUS

Now by the kingdoms of infernal rule,
Of Styx, of Acheron, and the fiery lake,
Of ever-burning Phlegethon, I swear,
That I do long to see the monuments
And situation of bright splendid Rome.
Come, therefore, let's away.

MEPHISTOPHELES

Nay stay, my Faustus; I know you'd see the Pope
And take some part of holy Peter's feast,
The which this day with high solemnity,
This day is held through Rome and Italy,
In honour of the Pope's triumphant victory.

FAUSTUS

Sweet Mephistopheles, thou pleasest me.
Whilst I am here on earth, let me be cloyed
With all things that delight the heart of man.
My four and twenty years of liberty
I'll spend in pleasure and in dalliance,
That Faustus' name, whilst this bright frame doth stand,
May be admired through the furthest land.

MEPHISTOPHELES

'Tis well said, Faustus. Come, then, stand by me
And thou shalt see them come immediately.

FAUSTUS

Nay, stay my gentle Mephistopheles,
And grant me my request, and then I go.
Thou know'st within the compass of eight days,
We viewed the face of heaven, of earth, and hell.
So high our dragons soared into the air,
That looking down the earth appeared to me,
No bigger than my hand in quantity.
There did we view the kingdoms of the world,
And what might please mine eye I there beheld.
Then in this show let me an actor be,
That this proud Pope may Faustus' cunning see.

MEPHISTOPHELES

Let it be so, my Faustus, but first stay
And view their triumphs as they pass this way.
And then devise what best contents thy mind,
By cunning in thine art to cross the Pope,
Or dash the pride of this solemnity,
To make his monks and abbots stand like apes,
And point like antics at his triple crown:
To beat the beads about the friars' pates,
Or clap huge horns, upon the cardinals' heads,
Or any villainy thou can'st devise,
And I'll perform it, Faustus. Hark, they come:
This day shall make thee be admired in Rome.

Turn over for the next question

or

0 5

John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of the Duchess and Bosola
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]**Act 3 Scene 2****DUCHESS**

This good one that you speak of, is my husband.

BOSOLA

Do I not dream? Can this ambitious age
Have so much goodness in't, as to prefer
A man merely for worth: without these shadows
Of wealth, and painted honours? possible?

DUCHESS

I have had three children by him.

BOSOLA

Fortunate lady,
For you have made your private nuptial bed
The humble and fair seminary of peace.
No question but many an unbenefic'd scholar
Shall pray for you, for this deed, and rejoice
That some preferment in the world can yet
Arise from merit. The virgins of your land,
That have no dowries, shall hope your example
Will raise them to rich husbands. Should you want
Soldiers, 'twould make the very Turks and Moors
Turn Christians, and serve you for this act.
Last, the neglected poets of your time,
In honour of this trophy of a man,
Rais'd by that curious engine, your white hand,
Shall thank you, in your grave, for't; and make that
More reverend than all the cabinets
Of living princes. For Antonio,
His fame shall likewise flow from many a pen,
When heralds shall want coats to sell to men.

DUCHESS

As I taste comfort, in this friendly speech,
So would I find concealment –

BOSOLA

Oh the secret of my prince,
Which I will wear on th' inside of my heart.

DUCHESS

You shall take charge of all my coin, and jewels,
And follow him, for he retires himself
To Ancona.

BOSOLA

So.

DUCHESS

Whither, within few days,
I mean to follow thee.

BOSOLA

Let me think:
I would wish your Grace to feign a pilgrimage
To Our Lady of Loretto, scarce seven leagues
From fair Ancona, so may you depart
Your country with more honour, and your flight
Will seem a princely progress, retaining
Your usual train about you.

DUCHESS

Sir, your direction
Shall lead me by the hand.

CARIOLA

In my opinion,
She were better progress to the baths at Lucca,
Or go visit the Spa
In Germany: for, if you will believe me,
I do not like this jesting with religion,
This feigned pilgrimage.

DUCHESS

Thou art a superstitious fool:
Prepare us instantly for our departure.
Past sorrows, let us moderately lament them,
For those to come, seek wisely to prevent them.

Exit [DUCHESS with CARIOLA].

BOSOLA

A politician is the devil's quilted anvil,
He fashions all sins on him, and the blows
Are never heard; he may work in a lady's chamber,
As here for proof. What rests, but I reveal
All to my lord? Oh, this base quality
Of intelligencer! Why, every quality i' th' world
Prefers but gain, or commendation:
Now for this act, I am certain to be rais'd,
And men that paint weeds, to the life, are prais'd.

Exit.

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

‘Willy Loman’s most significant tragic flaw is his lack of self-knowledge.’

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

‘The tragedy of *A Streetcar Named Desire* is caused by the weaknesses of the male characters.’

How far do you agree with this view of the way that the characters are presented in the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

In what ways is Ibsen’s use of the stage and the stage setting significant to the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

What is the tragic significance of waiting in *Waiting for Godot*?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

Consider the view that *Translations* is a tragedy driven by a failure of understanding.

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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